

SKILLS GUIDE



Ability to work in a team with site manager and coworkers, and strong multitasking skills.



Creativity to make decorative elements of furniture, unique trims, and fittings.



Good numerical skills for taking accurate measurements and making calculations.



Manual dexterity for using a wide range of hand and power tools to cut, shape, and join materials.



Physical strength for lifting heavy items and holding them in place while fixing them into position.



MILL WORKER Specializes in making wooden items in a workshop. These may include staircases, cupboards, doors, roof beams, and wardrobes.



CABINET MAKER/KITCHEN FITTER Installs and fits kitchen cupboards, worktops, and trims. Fitters follow layouts drawn up by a designer to achieve the look requested by their customers.



SITE CARPENTER/FRAMER Makes the wooden sections of a property on a building site. They also prepare scaffolds or forms (the molds that hold poured concrete).

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **PRODUCT DESIGNER** *see pp. 18–19*
- ▶ **BOAT BUILDER** Builds new boats or carries out repairs on existing vessels using a range of carpentry, engineering, and plumbing skills.
- ▶ **PAINTER AND DECORATOR** Applies paint, wallpaper, and other coatings to walls and surfaces of a building to improve its appearance.
- ▶ **ROOFER** Repairs and builds roofs on houses and commercial properties, using materials such as slates, tiles, and wood.
- ▶ **THEATER SET DESIGNER** Creates the sets that are used for stage shows. They use their artistic skills and knowledge of lighting and costumes to create the right visual setting for the production.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Woodwork • Engineering • Design technology • Construction • Mathematics • Art and design • Health and fitness



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS College courses in carpentry or joinery are not essential, but will help you find work. Apprenticeships are important.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are regular, but early starts are common. Carpenters may need to work overtime on some projects.



LOCATION Some jobs require work on site in harsh weather. Carpenters may need to work away from home for long periods on jobs located far away.



THE REALITIES Can be physically demanding and the financial rewards are modest, but building something can be very rewarding.